

29/01/2026

Rampant, Ajar, Torpid, Riddle, Nifty

1 Rampant (बेकाबू / तेज़ी से फैलता) (Adjective) (ram-pant) (Strongly Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Spreading or increasing uncontrollably; unchecked.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** बिना नियंत्रण के फैलने वाला।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old French *ramper* (to climb) → **Medieval Latin** → rampant
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** widespread, unchecked, rampant
 - **Antonyms:** controlled, restrained, limited
- **Connotation:** Negative (loss of control)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Weeds overtaking an abandoned field.



• Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):

In economics, public policy, and social research, *rampant* is used to describe problems that spread rapidly and remain unchecked. Analysts frequently refer to rampant inflation, corruption, or misinformation to emphasize the scale and lack of control surrounding these issues. When a problem becomes rampant, it signals systemic failure rather than isolated incidents. Public health studies also use the term to describe widespread disease transmission in the absence of effective containment measures. Non-fiction writers employ *rampant* to convey urgency and seriousness, highlighting conditions that

demand immediate structural intervention rather than minor adjustments or short-term fixes.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  Corruption is rampant in the system. (प्रणाली में भ्रष्टाचार बेकाबू रूप से फैल गया है।)
-  Corruption is rampant slowly. (गलत: “rampant” पहले से ही तेज़ और अनियंत्रित फैलाव दर्शाता है; इसे “slowly” जैसे शब्दों के साथ प्रयोग नहीं किया जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Watch for patterns that grow rampant when left unchecked—habits, expenses, ego, distractions. Growth without governance becomes damage. Set limits early, review regularly, and prune decisively. Healthy systems expand with intention; uncontrolled expansion consumes resources and undermines long-term stability and focus.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *Crime became rampant in the city.* (शहर में अपराध बेकाबू हो गया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): Crime
 - V (Verb – Linking): became
 - O (Object / Complement): rampant
 - (Adverbial Clause of Place): in the city

- **Common Collocations:**

- rampant corruption, rampant inflation, rampant growth

- **My Statement:**

- The rampant corruption in the country stagnated innovation in the long run.
- With such rampant inflation, I had no other option but to leave this place.
- It was difficult to manage the organization due to rampant growth over the past three years.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2 Ajar (थोड़ा खुला हुआ) (Adjective / Adverb) (a-jar) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** Slightly open; not fully closed.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** पूरी तरह बंद नहीं; थोड़ा खुला हुआ।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *ajarre* → **ajar**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** partly open, open slightly
 - **Antonyms:** shut, closed
- **Connotation:** Neutral / Descriptive
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A door left slightly open at night.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In security studies, architecture, and risk management writing, ajar is used to describe doors, windows, or systems that are slightly open and therefore vulnerable. Analysts often note that leaving access points ajar can compromise safety protocols, enabling unauthorized entry or data breaches. In organizational audits, an ajar process may refer metaphorically to a policy gap that has not been fully closed, allowing inefficiencies or misconduct to occur. Non-fiction writers use ajar to emphasize partial exposure rather than complete failure. The term signals caution, suggesting that even small oversights can create disproportionate risks if not promptly addressed.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  The door was left ajar during the night. (दरवाज़ा रात भर थोड़ा खुला रह गया था।)
-  The door was ajar wide open. (गलत: “ajar” का अर्थ ही थोड़ा खुला होना है; इसे “wide open” जैसे विपरीत अर्थ वाले शब्दों के साथ प्रयोग नहीं किया जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Keep opportunities slightly ajar. Total closure blocks growth; reckless openness invites chaos. Leave room for revision, learning, and unexpected insight. Progress often enters through half-open doors—those spaces where discipline meets curiosity and commitment allows flexibility without losing direction or standards.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *The window was ajar.* (खिड़की थोड़ी खुली थी।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The window
 - V (Verb – Linking): was
 - O (Object / Complement): ajar

- **Common Collocations:**

- door ajar, leave ajar

- **My Statement:**

- **ADJECTIVE**

- An ajar tiffin in the room caused an unpleasant smell.
- The ajar door is the reason there are so many mosquitoes in this room.
- You need a few doors left ajar in your life so you can begin from somewhere.

- **ADVERB**

- I told you to keep the door ajar.
- I cannot afford to keep my windows ajar in extreme winds.
- I entered the place because it was kept ajar.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3 Torpid (सुस्त / निष्क्रिय) (Adjective) (tor-pid) (Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Mentally or physically inactive; sluggish.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** शारीरिक या मानसिक रूप से सुस्त।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *torpere* (to be numb) → **torpid**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** lethargic, sluggish
 - **Antonyms:** active, energetic
- **Connotation:** Negative (lack of vitality)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person lying idle, lacking energy.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In economics, biology, and organizational analysis, torpid is used to describe states of inactivity, sluggishness, or reduced responsiveness. Economists may refer to a torpid market when growth stalls and investment confidence weakens. In biology, animals enter torpid states to conserve energy during unfavorable conditions such as cold or food scarcity. Organizational researchers also describe torpid institutions as those resistant to change, innovation, or reform. In non-fiction writing, torpid conveys more than simple slowness; it suggests a deeper lack of vitality that, if prolonged, can lead to stagnation or decline. The term highlights the need for external stimulus or internal reform to restore momentum and function.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  The economy remained torpid despite government stimulus. (सरकारी प्रोत्साहन के बावजूद अर्थव्यवस्था सुस्त बनी रही।)
-  The torpid athlete reacted instantly. (गलत: "torpid" सुस्ती या निष्क्रियता दर्शाता है; त्वरित और सक्रिय प्रतिक्रिया के साथ इसका प्रयोग नहीं किया जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Break torpid phases with deliberate sparks. When motivation slows, lower the entry barrier—start smaller, move briefly, act imperfectly. Momentum revives energy, not the other way around. Treat torpor as a signal to simplify action, not as a verdict on capability or intent.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *He felt torpid after the long journey.* (लंबी यात्रा के बाद वह सुस्त महसूस कर रहा था।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): He
 - V (Verb – Linking): felt
 - O (Object / Complement): torpid
 - (Adverbial Clause of Time / Cause): after the long journey

- **Common Collocations:**

- torpid state, torpid response

- **My Statement:**

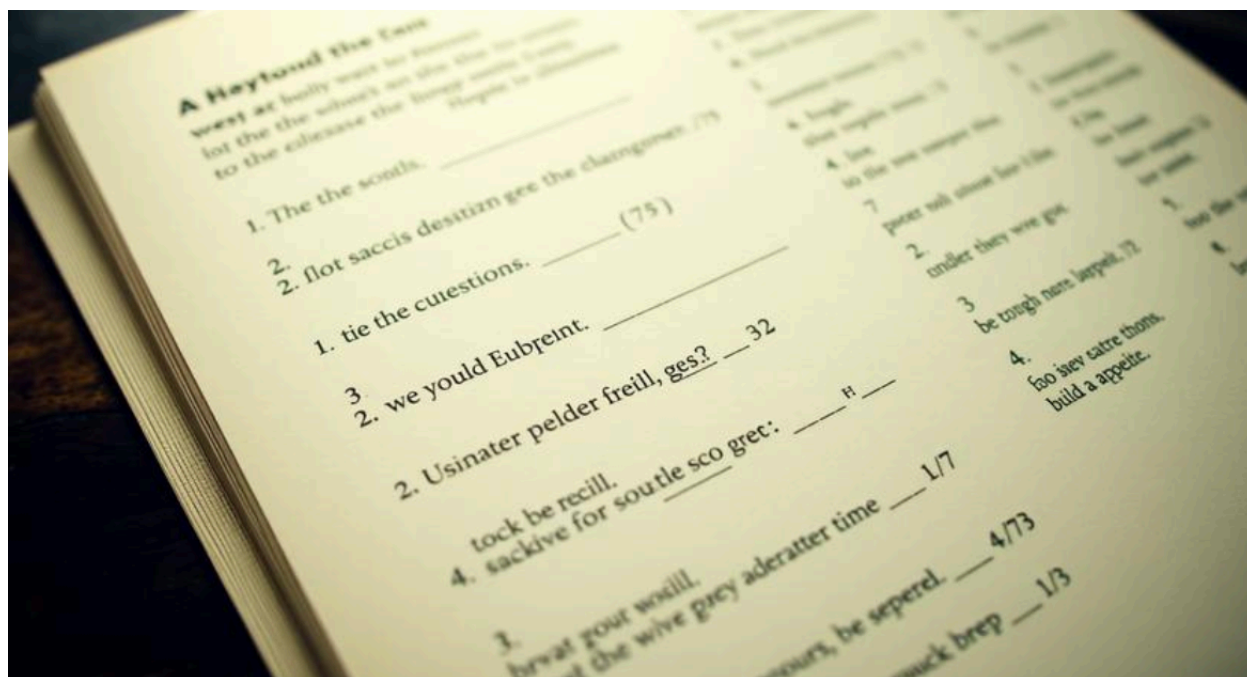
- You need to move away from such a torpid state.
- The response regarding execution was torpid, showing little urgency or energy.
- The system has remained torpid for the last 12 hours.

- **My Notes:**

-  **We received a torpid response about how execution has to be done.**
 - torpid describes lack of energy or movement, not clarity or quality of information.
 - A response cannot be torpid unless you mean slow or delayed—and even then it's awkward.
-  **There has been torpid activity for the last 12 hours.**
 - torpid activity is contradictory: activity implies motion; torpid implies lack of it.

4 Riddle (पहेली / भर देना) (Noun / Verb) (rid-dle) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** A puzzling question; to fill something with holes or problems.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** पहेली; किसी चीज़ को समस्याओं से भर देना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *ræde/s* → **riddle**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** puzzle, enigma
 - **Antonyms:** solution, answer
- **Connotation:** Neutral (intellectual complexity)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A page filled with cryptic questions.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In history, science, and investigative journalism, riddle is used to describe problems or situations that resist easy explanation. Scholars often refer to unresolved questions—such as the origins of ancient civilizations or unexplained scientific phenomena—as riddles that invite ongoing research. In policy analysis, reports may describe systems riddled with contradictions or inefficiencies, highlighting complexity rather than mystery. Non-fiction writers employ riddle both literally and metaphorically to signal intellectual challenge, uncertainty, or layered meaning. Its use draws attention to gaps in understanding and encourages critical inquiry, reminding readers that some issues require patience, evidence, and sustained reasoning before clarity can emerge.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  The case remains a riddle to investigators. (यह मामला जाँचकर्ताओं के लिए अब भी एक पहेली बना हुआ है।)
-  The riddle solution was very obvious and simple. (गलत: "riddle" किसी जटिल या रहस्यमय समस्या को दर्शाता है; इसे "बहुत स्पष्ट और सरल" जैसे अर्थों के साथ प्रयोग नहीं किया जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Treat challenges as riddles, not roadblocks. Instead of reacting emotionally, decode patterns, constraints, and hidden assumptions. Every riddle has clues if you slow down and observe. Curiosity reframes difficulty into engagement, turning frustration into structured problem-solving and steady progress.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *The mystery remains a riddle.* (रहस्य एक पहेली बना हुआ है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The mystery
 - V (Verb – Linking): remains
 - O (Object / Complement): a riddle

- **Common Collocations:**

- riddle with problems, solve a riddle

- **My Statement:**

- **NOUN**

- I solve a riddle daily.
- Where can I find a riddle to solve?
- I got a book filled with riddles.

- **VERB**

- He was riddled with problems since he left the university.
- The question paper options were riddled with dark black ink marks.
- The ancient text is riddled with cryptic meanings that need to be revealed.

- **My Notes:**

-  The question paper options were riddled with a dark black pen.
 - Riddled with does not mean written or marked.
 - It implies damage, excess, or negative saturation, not handwriting.
- Riddled with = excessively filled in a damaging / undesirable way

5 Nifty (चतुर / उपयोगी) (Adjective) (nif-ty) (Positive / Informal)

- **Meaning (English):** Clever, useful, or impressively effective.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** चतुर या सुविधाजनक।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Colloquial English (19th century) → **nifty**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** clever, handy
 - **Antonyms:** clumsy, awkward
- **Connotation:** Positive (efficiency, ingenuity)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A compact tool performing multiple functions.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In technology writing, consumer reviews, and innovation studies, nifty is used to describe solutions or features that are clever, efficient, and user-friendly. Analysts often highlight nifty tools or design choices that simplify complex tasks without requiring extensive resources. In productivity research, nifty techniques are praised for maximizing output while minimizing effort. Although informal in tone, the word appears in non-fiction when accessibility and relatability are prioritized over formality. Writers use nifty to convey practical ingenuity rather than grandeur, emphasizing usefulness, smart design, and the value of small but effective improvements in everyday systems and workflows.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  She found a nifty solution to the problem. (उसने समस्या का एक चतुर और उपयोगी समाधान ढूँढ लिया।)
-  The accident was nifty and tragic. (गलत: “nifty” सकारात्मक अर्थ रखता है—चतुर, सुविधाजनक या उपयोगी; इसे दुखद या नकारात्मक घटनाओं के साथ प्रयोग नहीं किया जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Seek nifty solutions—small, clever improvements that save time, effort, or energy. Progress doesn’t always require grand change; it often comes from smart tweaks. Optimize routines, automate where possible, and value elegance. A nifty adjustment today can compound into significant gains tomorrow.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *She came up with a nifty idea.* (उसने एक चतुर विचार सुझाया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Phrasal, Transitive): came up with
 - O (Object): a nifty idea

- **Common Collocations:**

- nifty trick, nifty solution

- **My Statement:**

- The company needs a nifty trick to optimize its algorithms for specific requirements.
- A senior engineer proposed a nifty solution to the team.
- To help investors make lower-risk stock choices, we came up with our own variant inspired by the Nifty 50.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]